



DAY ZERO ENERGY

EXECUTIVE INTELLIGENCE FOR ENERGY LEADERS

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Nigeria · Decommissioning & Abandonment · HSE Safety Intelligence

ROAD TO SEPTEMBER 9 · EDITION 9

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What Complete Looks Like

The template asks what you have.

The Regulations ask what is true.

EIGHT DAYS. EIGHT CHECKS. ONE FILING.

EXECUTIVE SNAPSHOT

Eight days out, the analytical work is done. What remains is assembly. This edition is the completeness pass: eight checks, each anchored to a provision, that separate a filing which answers the Regulations from a filing which merely resembles one. The test is not whether the document is thick. It is whether each limb the Regulations name is present, priced, and honest about its own uncertainty.

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF

A template answers one question: what does a plan look like. The Regulations answer a different one: what must a plan contain. The two overlap, and they are not the same. A filing assembled from a template can be complete by accident. A filing assembled from Regulation 5(13) is complete by construction. With eight days left, construction is the only method that can still be trusted.

What follows is the completeness pass. Eight checks. Run them in order, against the actual document, with the actual authors in the room.

THE EIGHT CHECKS

- 1. The duty.** Regulation 23 makes the filing mandatory. The first check is the plainest: the plan exists, it is complete enough to sign, and it will be in on time.
- 2. The skeleton.** Regulation 5(13) is the contents list for the decommissioning programme. Read it limb by limb against your table of contents. Every limb it names is present in the filing, or the filing is not complete, whatever its page count.
- 3. The count.** Regulation 5(13)(e) requires an inventory of all materials, including hydrocarbons, sludges, sacrificial anodes and LSA scale, and it closes with the line that decides borderline cases: where exact quantities cannot be verified, estimates shall be calculated. An empty cell is not an answer the Regulations recognise. An estimate is.

4. The wells. Regulation 5(13)(e)(ii) requires every well listed, whether active, suspended or abandoned, with the plug and abandonment details attached. Suspended wells are inventory. Leaving them out does not defer them. It just makes the filing incomplete.

5. The restoration limb. Regulation 5(13)(g) puts restoration inside the programme. Present as its own limb, not implied somewhere inside a method statement.

6. The honest number. Regulation 5(13)(j) requires the cost estimate to carry the category of expenditures, the basis of the best estimate, and an indication of potential deviations. A single top-line figure fails this provision on its face. Categories, basis, deviations. All three, or the estimate is not what the Regulations asked for.

7. The monitoring scope. Regulation 15 places post-decommissioning monitoring inside the regime and fixes no duration for it. That silence is not permission to ignore it. It is an obligation to state the assumption: what window the estimate prices, and on what basis it was chosen.

8. The money read forward. Regulation 20 derives the annual contribution from the approved estimate, and Regulation 19(5) governs where the Fund sits. The number in check six is not a filing figure. It is the seed of an annuity, and the filing should be signed by people who understand that.

THE BOARDROOM QUESTION

If the Commission read our filing against Regulation 5(13) limb by limb, which limb would fail first, and who in this room can name it today?

WHERE FILINGS FALL SHORT

The template pass. The document mirrors a consultant's template and nobody has checked it against Regulation 5(13) itself. Completeness by resemblance is not completeness.

The empty cell. Quantities that could not be verified were left blank instead of estimated. Regulation 5(13)(e) already told you what to do with them: estimates shall be calculated.

The single number. One top-line cost, no categories, no stated basis, no deviations. Regulation 5(13)(j) names all three, and the Commission can read.

The silent assumption. Monitoring priced, or not priced, with no stated window. Regulation 15 fixes no duration, which means the filing must declare its own, or the estimate rests on an assumption nobody signed.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

This filing is the first document the Commission will ever read from your company under this regime. It sets the reputation of your file, and files have long memories. Completeness is the cheapest credibility available this week: it costs a reading of Regulation 5(13) and an honest pass through your own document. And because Regulation 20 turns the approved estimate into an annual payment, the number you file is a number you will live with. File what is true, state what is assumed, and make sure the people signing understand which is which.

THIS WEEK

Read Regulation 5(13) aloud against the filing's table of contents. Mark every limb present, partial, or missing.

Convert every blank quantity into a calculated estimate with a stated basis, as Regulation 5(13)(e) directs.

State the monitoring window as a written assumption with its basis, and put it where the Commission will find it stated, not buried.

DAY ZERO INSIGHT

A complete filing is not the thickest one. It is the one with nothing missing.

Every blank cell is a question the Commission will ask later, at a worse time.

File what is true, state what is assumed, and sign it.

EXECUTIVE CHECKLIST

- Regulation 5(13) read limb by limb against the filing's contents.
- Inventory complete, with calculated estimates where quantities could not be verified.
- Every well listed with plug and abandonment details, including suspended wells.
- Cost estimate carries categories, best-estimate basis, and potential deviations.
- Monitoring window stated as an assumption with its basis.
- Signatories briefed that the estimate seeds the Regulation 20 annual contribution.

LOOKING AHEAD

Edition Ten is the last. One day out, it turns from the filing to the morning after: what begins on September 10, and why the road does not actually end.